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ADVANCED CUSTOMER SCHEDULING

Version 3.5.2

Product Guide



FRONTISPIECE

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This manual relates to:

Advanced Customer Scheduling Version 3.5.2

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Glossary



Glossary

Arrears Processing Method

This is specified on the contract and is used in the reconciliation process. It may take the following values:

'01' - Normal

The customer will either state a cumulative arrears figure or state individual past due requirements with their past due date.

'02' - Restated

The customer will not state arrears figures as such but will restate any arrears as new current / future dated requirements.

'03' - Assumed

The customer assumes the supplier knows what the arrears figure is and that the supplier will send them automatically.

Advanced Shipment Notifications (ASNs)

An ASN is an EDI message transmitted when a shipment leaves a supplier's premises. The message informs the customer of the shipment details.

Authorisation Method

This is specified on the contract. It states how the supplier should identify which authorisation period each schedule requirement belongs to. It has the following values:

'01' - Customer Sent

Each requirement is coded accordingly. E.g. Code 1 - this is a FIRM requirement.

'02' - Date Horizons

Customer states date horizons for each authorisation period and each requirement is coded according to their 'first required' date.

'03' - Cumulative Quantity

Customer states cumulative cut off points for each authorisation period. The requirements are read in date sequence and coded accordingly. Requirements which cross the break off point are put entirely in the earlier authorisation period.

'04' - Fixed Horizons

The authorisation period end dates are always a fixed number of days (as specified on the contract) after the schedule issue date. The requirements are coded as per method 02.

All DCI and RAN requirements are in authorisation period 1.

Authorisation Periods

Advanced Customer Scheduling allows for up to five authorisation periods, although more typically there are just three: FIRM or FABRICATE, MATERIAL, and FORECAST. There are four different methods for determining the authorisation period of each schedule requirement on a 'Release'.

Accepted practice is that the customer is contractually obliged to pay the item price for FIRM requirements and the raw material cost for MATERIAL requirements. There is no contractual obligation associated with FORECAST requirement; the customer sends these to the supplier purely for longer term planning purposes.

Comparison Method

This defines which schedule to use as base for comparison purposes. It is partnered with rules when attached to contracts. There are four types of comparison method; the first two are for new schedules and the latter two are for new revisions of existing schedules.

1 - New Release / Previous Release, Latest Revision

For example the customer sends a new release which would be Internal Reference 2, revision 0. Compare it to the current release i.e. Internal Reference 1, revision 10.

2 - New Release / Previous Release, Revision Zero

In the above example, compare the new release, Internal Reference 2, revision 0 to historical release Internal Reference 1, revision 0.

3 - New Revision / Previous Revision

E.g. the customer sends a new revision of a schedule which would be Internal Reference 2, revision 2. Compare it to current schedule Internal Reference 2, revision 1.

4 - New Revision / Revision Zero

In the above example, new schedule Internal Reference 2, revision 2 would be compared to historical schedule Internal Reference 2, revision 0.

Multiple comparison methods / rules may be attached to a contract (at Release and / or DCI level).

On-line comparison only processes the element 1 portion of a comparison rule and uses the Primary rule, though this may be overridden.

Comparison Rule Elements

Define where the amount being compared should be evaluated. There are five possible elements;

1 - Quantity within period.

This element type is associated with a range of days which are relative to the schedule issue date. There may only be one negative range, -999 to -1 (i.e. all arrears). There may be numerous positive day ranges but with no overlaps. E.g. range **0** - 10 means look at the 'Amount' (Quantity / Percentage / Sales Value) in the first 10 days of the new schedule and compare it to the 'amount' in the corresponding 10 days of the comparison schedule.

2 - Cumulative at authorisation period end (new date)

This element type is associated with an authorisation period (1 to 5). It says look at the 'Amount' at the period end date for the **new** schedule and compare it to the 'Amount' on the comparison schedule at the same date.

3 - Cumulative at authorisation period end (new / current date).

This is like element 2 but compares the 'Amount' at the new end date of the relevant period on the new schedule to the value at current end date of the corresponding period on the comparison schedule.

4 - Cumulative at high water mark.

This element type is associated with an authorisation period (1 - 5). It says look at the 'Amount' at the High Water mark on the new schedule and compare it to the 'Amount' at the High Water Mark on the comparison schedule.

5 - Cumulative mismatch.

This is a special element which has no date range or authorisation period associated with it. Also it does not compare 'new' schedule data to a base schedule. Instead it calculates customer's implied goods in transit in two different ways (see Reconciliation Method 03) and evaluates the size of any difference to determine whether an 'exception' has been encountered.

Consignment Stocks

Consignment stock processing is used when a supplier transfers goods to a holding area, generally known as a consignment warehouse, instead of to a customer. The goods remain the property of the supplier and are referred to as consignment stock. At this stage no updates are made to inventory, invoice records are not created and the shipment is converted to a transfer order.

The customer has direct access to these goods and takes them from the warehouse as they are required. The customer then notifies the supplier that they have consumed these goods and upon receipt of this notification inventory is updated and an invoice is raised.

Consignment stock processing and self billing are often performed together as the customer notification of stock consumption can be used to match a self billed invoice.

Contract

The 'contract' specifies the agreed terms between the supplying company (the user) and his customer, to provide a quantity of a specified item over a specified

timescale, usually with agreed contract prices. It also parameterises how the system should receive and process schedule data from the customer for that contract.

A contract may operate with Releases only; Releases and DCI's; or Releases and RAN's. For the latter two, all 'Release' demand is ignored by Shipping. The customer may send overlapping Releases and DCI / RANS. The system does not double count the demand.

DCI

This **D**aily **C**all **I**n is a short term (typically the next 7 - 14 days) mini 'Release' specifying FIRM requirements only.

Internal Reference Numbers

These are two 5 digit system generated labels which identify a particular schedule and it's associated records. A contract which operates Releases and DCI's / RAN's will have two sets of reference numbers.

The customer will state whether they are sending a new or revised schedule. Typically a new schedule may come out say monthly, whereas a new revision is reissuing the same schedule with minor changes.

RAN

A **R**eceipt **A**dvice **N**otification is a special 'DCI'. RAN's are sent with a unique RAN identifier which must be quoted on all despatch documentation. They are discrete authorisations to ship which must be shipped in their entirety on a single consignment. There is no arrears concept with RAN's; if missed or short despatched, the customer will restate demand in a new RAN if they still want the goods.

Reconciliation Method

This is specified on the contract. It states what kind of information the customer will provide regarding cumulative receipts and hence how the customer's and supplier's view of despatches / receipts should be reconciled. It can have any of the following values:

'01' - Cumulative Quantity.

The customer status cumulative receipts to date and the system needs to determine which despatches have been received and which are still Goods in Transit (GIT).

'02' - Last Despatch.

The customer quotes back up to six last despatches received (by consignment number). The system will flag these as received on the despatches file, and the goods in transit will be calculated from those despatches not flagged as received.

'03' - Cumulative Quantity and Last Despatch.

In this case the system can calculate goods in transit two different ways, which should concur. This may uncover a cumulative mismatch which implies the data on the schedule is in error.

'04' - Assumed.

The system assumes the customer has received all shipments despatched up to the issue date less ship lead time.

'05' - RAN.

There is no reconciliation process for RAN's; each one is viewed as a discrete order, without any concept of arrears or goods in transit.

'06' - None.

The system assumes the customer to have received all shipments despatched up to the issue date, regardless of Ship Lead Time.

The customer view of arrears may include their implied view of goods in transit - the system adjusts for this in the reconciliation process.

Release

This is a schedule for an extended time frame (typically six months in Europe, or three months in North America). It may split requirements into different 'Authorisation Periods'.

Revision Numbers

These are two 5 digit system generated labels which identify a particular schedule and its associated records. A contract which operates Releases and DCI's / RAN's will have two sets of reference numbers.

The customer will state whether they are sending a new or revised schedule. Typically a new schedule may come out say monthly, whereas a new revision is reissuing the same schedule with minor changes.

Schedule

This is a generic term relating to a set of requirement data against a specified contract. The term 'schedule' can apply to a 'Release', 'DCI', or a 'RAN'.

Self Billing

Self billing allows the customer to reduce the cost of matching invoices against consignment notes by calculating the invoice they are expecting from the supplier. The customer notifies the supplier of the invoice details that it has raised against itself.

Consignment stock processing and self billing are often performed together as the customer notification of stock consumption can be used to match a self billed invoice.

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